

matically. If you're going on a long outing with no spares, it's a good idea to turn off the LCD display. Using just the viewfinder to take photographs will drastically reduce the power consumption of the camera. Turn your camera off when not in use, and don't waste power by reviewing your work. If your battery is critically low, and you still have to take photographs, compose the shot, turn the camera on, click the trigger, then quickly turn off the camera.

10.10 Battery Chargers

If you own a digital camera, chances are that you use a charger either for the AA batteries or the proprietary battery.

Always use the specified charger that accompanied the batteries. Eventually, the batteries will lose their capacity to be recharged. Manage sets of batteries in such a way, that they all have the same amount of charge and usage at any point of time.

Don't store batteries in the charger. These batteries will drain slowly, and may leak into the charger. Whenever possible use a reputed brand, and consult the manual of the camera for supported battery types. If the batteries are heating up when you charge them, replace the entire set, as this means that the batteries are of a low quality that can damage your camera. Completely charge a set, then drain it completely in the camera before charging again. Make sure that the charger indicates when the charge is complete, so you do not end up overcharging the batteries, which can make it heat up or ruin it.

If you are using a proprietary battery, it is very important to invest in another one. Follow the complete charge-drain-charge cycle for such batteries as well. Use the charger of the same brand, or the charger that came with the camera. Don't keep the battery for charging without monitoring the process, as overcharging can ruin the battery. Make sure that there is an automatic cutoff or some kind of indicator for a complete charge.

While traveling, and especially when traveling overseas, you might face problems with finding compatible power outlets. It always makes sense to invest in a plug, with multiple configurations of pins or a universal adapter.